A-A-53346
15 January 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, EAR (Oval Cup, House)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a House-style oval cup ear forceps used for microsurgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The jaws of the forceps shall be 4 mm long, angled 15 degrees to the right or left, and have smooth edges. The shaft handle junction shall be designed for easy unlocking and effective clearing. The definition of the terms and components used in this specification are in accordance with ASTM F921. Performance shall be in accordance with applicable requirements of ASTM F1026.

Material. The material of the ear forceps shall be Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

Hardness. The ear forceps shall have a Rockwell hardness of C-47 to C-52. The hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Standard E18 or ASTM Standards E92 and E140.

Style and design and dimensions. The forceps shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing 24555.

Finish. The finish of the forceps shall be mirror, satin or matte. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform nondirectional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Boil test. The forceps shall meet the boil test requirements specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Copper sulfate test. The forceps shall meet the copper sulfate test requirements specified in GG-I-526.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Specific performance. The top lever arm shall be capable of disengaging from the lever pivot for raising and cleaning. The pivot mechanism and lever guide shall operate smoothly and freely without binding. The pivot mechanism shall be sufficiently tight to ensure correct alignment of the tips with no free-play or overlap of the tips. The tip mating surfaces shall mate cleanly with no discernable gap at any point of the surfaces.

Identification marking. The forceps shall bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from burrs, cracks, sharp edges, scale, corrosion or other detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One ear forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps. Defects shall be those listed below.

Defects

Forceps not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.

Finish of the forceps not specified.

Style and design not as specified.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. AQL shall be 1.0 (percent defective) with an inspection level of S-2.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the rights to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE. The following National Stock Number (s) is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-104-8342	FORCEPS, EAR, 0.9 mm Oval Cup, House, Jaws Angled 15 degrees Left
6515-00-104-8356	FORCEPS, EAR, 0.9 mm Oval Cup, House, Jaws Angled 15 degrees Right

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 45339 Project No. 6515-4099

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 Alexandria VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions — Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53346	FORCEPS, FAR (Oval Cup, House)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* — Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* — Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* — Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.